



Money for a home that does not exist yet, held until it does.

Escrow on Avalanche for off-plan buyers and the Kenyan diaspora building back home. Money in by M-Pesa, released one stage at a time against photographs that pass four checks and a trustee's signature.

Daniel Mwihoti and Soni Mwangi · datum-roan.vercel.app · Avalanche Pitch Perfect, September 2026

THE PROBLEM

You pay, and you pray.

Off-plan buyers

Deposits and instalments go straight into a developer's account. When the project stalls, and many do, there is no practical way to get the money back. Everyone in Nairobi knows someone this happened to.

The diaspora

Kenyans abroad send money home for a house on their own plot. What they get back is photos on WhatsApp. Whose plot is that? Which year? The same three pictures again? By the time they know, the money is gone.

Both groups trust a stranger with money and get a promise back. Neither has a lender, an insurer or a court that can help after the fact.

WHAT DATUM DOES

Proof before release.

1 · Verified people

Every account is a proven number or email with its own Avalanche address. Listers pay KES 200 and are verified in person by Datum staff before anything goes live.

2 · Money into escrow

Commit to a listing, pay in instalments by M-Pesa. Each confirmed payment becomes a claim in a smart contract, in shillings. The builder cannot touch it.

3 · Photographs checked

Taken at the plot (GPS), taken recently, never submitted before (perceptual hash), showing the stage claimed (vision model). Then a trustee looks and countersigns.

4 · Or everyone is refunded

Two of three signatures release one stage's share and nothing more. Thirty quiet days and anyone can declare the project stalled; unreleased money comes back pro rata.

THE PRODUCT

The drawdown register.

The same document a bank and a quantity surveyor would both recognise: what is held, what was released, against which evidence, signed by whom. Live for every project, readable by anyone.

Every release links to the photographs that earned it, the bundle hash on chain, and the transaction.

Drawdown register

Project Willow Park Block A, Kilimanjaro Status Active Ledger 0x5bd2bad8... Operator sign out Sender page ...

Off-plan buyers in Kenya pay for homes that do not exist yet. The money goes into a developer's account, and if the build stalls there is no way to get it back. Datum holds those deposits in escrow and releases them only against construction that has been proven to exist.

1 - BUYERS PAY IN

Deposits arrive by M-Pesa and are held by a smart contract, denominated in shillings. The developer cannot touch them.

2 - THE SITE IS PHOTOGRAPHED

Each milestone needs geotagged photographs. Four checks run on every one: it was taken at the site, taken recently, never submitted before, and shows the stage claimed.

3 - TWO OF THREE SIGN

The evidence pipeline is one signature. A licensed surveyor, the person whose money it is, or the platform is the second. No single party, including us, can move money alone.

4 - OR EVERYONE IS REFUNDED

If the project goes quiet for 30 days, any buyer can declare it stalled. Whatever was never released comes back, pro rata, no matter who claims first.

Milestone schedule Funds release only against verified evidence

01 20%	02 40%	03 60%	04 80%	05 100%
Site clearing and foundation 1 of 2 signed	Ground floor slab	First floor structure	Roofing complete	Finishing and handover

Buyer deposits

KES 650

Still protected

KES 650

Released to developer

KES 0

Verified milestones

0 / 5

1 - Site evidence

BUILDER

The builder submits three geotagged photographs of the current stage. Location, recency, novelty and stage are checked before anything moves.

Photographs

Choose Files | No file chosen

Submit for verification

2 - Countersign

TWO OF THREE REQUIRED

The evidence pipeline is one attester. The sender, 254722114050, approves from their own page; the platform can countersign instead if they ask us to.

Platform confirms

If the builder walks away

Unreleased funds are returned pro rata. Claim order changes nothing.

Verification result SITE CLEARING AND FOUNDATION

Evidence rejected

1 of 1 images passed, 3 required.

foundation_4.jpg

location recent not reused stage match

Within 0m of the registered site · Captured 3 days ago · Shows foundation (100% confidence)

Bundle hash 0x4c4e7d0b6301e3903b7f8eb73277946673b2013423317b8f80cF5456a91d22a

Public record check BACKSTREET HOMES LTD

Photographs prove what the camera saw. Public records prove the company still exists.

Developer

Willow Park Developments Ltd

YOUR APPROVAL IS NEEDED

GROUND FLOOR SLAB

The builder says this milestone is done and the photographs passed every check. Nothing is released until you say so — look at them and decide.



AT YOUR PLOT

RECENT

NOT SENT BEFORE

STAGE MATCHES

Within 0m of the registered site · Captured 2 days ago · Shows ground slab (100% confidence)



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Approve and release

Not satisfied

Approving releases only this milestone's share. The rest of your money stays in escrow until the next stage is proven.

THE MOMENT THAT MATTERS

The person whose money it is holds a signature.

On a remittance build the sender approves each stage from the photographs, from their phone, wherever they are. The fundi cannot release money alone, and neither can we.

Wrong plot, old photo, recycled photo, wrong stage: each is rejected before a human ever looks.

WHO IT IS FOR

Lead with the diaspora. It is the sharpest pain and the cleanest sale.

Senders abroad

KES 300k to 3M over one to three years to a relative or fundi they cannot supervise. Already paying remittance fees; will pay for certainty.

Off-plan buyers

Nairobi metro buyers who want the developer to prove progress before each instalment.

Developers and companies

Lose sales to distrust. "Your money is in escrow, not with us" is a sales tool, and the register is what their bank asks for.

Trustees

Surveyors, valuers and advocates who already inspect sites and want a paid, defensible, on-chain record of their sign-off.

BUSINESS MODEL

Paid by the people the trust is for.

Onboarding fee, live today

KES 200

On each milestone released

1 to 1.5%

Verification visit, per listing

flat fee

Developers with several projects

monthly

On a KES 3M build, the sender pays KES 200 once and KES 30k to 45k over the whole build, less than one wasted trip home. Datum's cost is a handful of Avalanche transactions and a trustee visit per milestone, which the visit fee covers. Everything beyond the KES 200 fee is proposed, not yet charged.

TRACTION

Built in three weeks. Live. Proven on chain with real M-Pesa money.

Escrows deployed on Avalanche

3

Actions recorded on chain

17 / 17

Full lifecycle proven

in → release →
refund

Tests passing

48 + 9

What is real

- Live app on Vercel against Avalanche Fuji
- Real M-Pesa sandbox payments credited to escrow
- Three contracts, 67 commits, open source

What is exercised

- Every evidence check, with real Kenyan site photographs
- Six accounts across four roles, two verified on chain
- Two listings live, each with its own escrow and trustee

What is not yet

- Paying customers
- A licensed settlement partner
- Production M-Pesa

WHY AVALANCHE

Rules nobody at Datum can override, at a cost nobody notices.

The release logic is code

Two of three signatures, cumulative percentages, snapshot refunds. Not a policy, not a promise: a contract anyone can read and nobody can bend.

A record you can hand to a lender

Every action, by every person, hashed against their own address. A buyer's trace is evidence, not a screenshot.

Cents and seconds

A remittance build is dozens of transactions. On Avalanche that is affordable and final within seconds, which is what a sender abroad waiting on a release needs.

Personal data never touches the chain. Names, numbers, emails and ID details stay in Postgres under the Data Protection Act; the chain carries addresses and hashes.

TEAM

Founders

Daniel Mwihoti

FOUNDER • PRODUCT AND ENGINEERING

Built the contracts, the evidence pipeline with its own perceptual hash, the M-Pesa integration and the app.

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Soni Mwangi

CO-FOUNDER

Partnerships, operations and the ground game: trustees, developers, diaspora networks and the verification visits that make the platform trustworthy.

THE ASK

Four introductions.

A licensed trust or e-money partner

To hold the shillings the token mirrors. The chain is the ledger and the authorisation, never the bank.

A production M-Pesa paybill

Everything runs on the Daraja sandbox today. Going live is onboarding, not code.

Three developers and one diaspora SACCO

To pilot with real buildings and real instalments.

Surveyors and valuers

To act as paid trustees and do the verification visits.

TRY IT

Scan, pick who you are, commit to a listing.

Sign in with any number or email using the demo code **246810**.
Everything you do is written on chain against your own address,
and you can trace it.

datum-roan.vercel.app · github.com/Talent-Index/datum ·
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